Gina C. Pieters

Education
MA & Ph.D. Economics, University of Minnesota (Ph.D. 2012)
B.A. Economics, Highest Honors, UC Santa Cruz
B.S. Physics, University of California, Santa Cruz

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C.V. version: November 2026

Current Positions

2023–Present **Digital Economy Research and Consulting**

Independent economic research and analysis.

Founder & Principal Economist

Selected clients:

- Co-lead economist on R3's CBDC development project: macroeconomic, monetary, and fiscal-stability impact analysis for the central bank, MATLAB simulations of dynamic general equilibrium models of CBDC adoption and its effects on interest rates and exchange rates, a literature review, and a 150-page group report; co-led stakeholder meetings.
- Stablecoin researcher for FI Consulting: solo-authored an 80-page report on stablecoin impact, with data analysis.
- Curriculum evaluator for "Digital Assets for Regulators" (CCAF, Cambridge Judge Business School).

Selected Other Positions (Volunteer or Past)

2025–Present **NABE Chicago**

Chicago chapter of the National Association for Business Economics: a forum for academics, economists, business leaders, and students, with events on economic issues affecting US businesses.

Board Director for Monetary Policy and Executive Committee Advisor

- Develop the chapter's programming on monetary policy and on the fintech, finance, and asset-market questions where they meet it: recruit speakers, moderate or sit on panels, take part in event discussion, and draw attendees from professional networks.

2025–2026 **Confusion Capital**

Capital management company in the Reserve ecosystem.

Lead Research Economist

Quantitative research developing on-chain index products.

- Designed reusable quantitative research tools for portfolio simulation and backtesting, parameter selection, stress testing, and benchmark comparison, with explicit controls for fees, taxes, and overfitting: quasi-random (Sobol) and adaptive-grid parameter search with Morris sensitivity screens; walk-forward and holdout validation; hidden semi-Markov regime models with Monte Carlo scenario ensembles; multiple-testing corrections (deflated Sharpe ratio, probability of backtest overfitting, White's reality check, and Hansen's SPA test); and ETF, fund, and crypto data pipelines feeding target-tracking portfolio optimization (CVXPY). Documented the parameter-search method in a 69-page methods document.
- Converted early investment concepts into documented, testable product proposals and supported evidence-based decisions to launch, revise, or retire them, with a standardized strategy report and LLM companion packages for proposed products.
- Reviewed investment methodologies for model risk, survivorship bias, transaction costs, liquidity, and implementation feasibility, using point-in-time crypto universes that keep dead coins and look-ahead causality checks, translating findings into portfolio and deployment recommendations.
- Built auditable AI workflows for research, simulation, writing, and code review, directing LLM-assisted development (Claude Code, Codex) and multi-agent research and audit systems, and setting up a Git-based workspace, and connected research findings to product positioning, controlled launches, and customer feedback.

2018–2025 **Cambridge Centre for Alternative Finance (CCAF), Judge Business School, University of Cambridge**

Interdisciplinary research centre at Cambridge Judge Business School, founded in 2015, studying alternative finance.

Co-chair, Emergent Money Systems Working Group, Cambridge Digital Assets Programme (2022–2025)

Co-led and advised research programmes.

- Working group on the measures of new forms of money that institutions and policymakers need.
- Co-lead of the Cambridge Digital Money Dashboard: reviewed the text and data work.
- Co-chaired stakeholder meetings with regulators, international organizations, and multinationals.

Honorary Non-Visiting Research Fellow (2018–2024)

Research advisor and reviewer; co-authored and edited CCAF reports.

2018–2024 **The University of Chicago**

Private research university in Chicago.

Visiting Instructor, Harris School of Public Policy (2024)

Taught a macroeconomics policy course: the Solow–Swan model applied to named policy projects, total factor productivity from the Penn World Table, and macroeconomic and trade data from the World Bank, IMF, and UN Comtrade.

Lecturer/Assistant Instructional Professor, Economics Department (2018–2024)

- Taught five economics courses a year across macroeconomics, microeconomics, international monetary systems, and economic policy analysis. Also taught Cryptoasset Markets, a master's course in the Financial Mathematics Program, as a summer overload.
- Advised MA theses and undergraduate honors projects.
- Managed the department's hiring of teaching assistants and graders, undergraduate to Ph.D. students, for its undergraduate and MA courses.
- Courses taught general-equilibrium and policy models with Lagrangian and dynamic-programming methods, simulated in MATLAB, Dynare, or Python, and data work with FRED series; Cryptoasset Markets added exchange data pulled through APIs in Python, backtesting without look-ahead, and regressions of returns on fundamentals and search attention.
- Conducted research alongside teaching.

Associate Fellow (Pedagogy), Chicago Center for Teaching & Learning (2022–2023)

Mentoring fellow for the next cohort of the Pedagogy Fellows Program, mentoring instructional and research faculty at every rank from entering to full professor, after a year as a Pedagogy Fellow (2021–2022).

2023–Present **AEA: CSWEP (Committee on the Status of Women in the Economics Profession)**

The American Economic Association's standing committee on women in economics.

Committee Member & Newsletter Oversight Editor

Manage its newsletter, *CSWEP News*.

2018–2024 **International Trade and Finance Association**

Professional association of economists working on international trade and finance.

Board of Directors (3×2 *yr.*)

Reviewed and refereed papers, and helped shape conference themes around current economic events and research.

2012–2018 **Trinity University, San Antonio, Texas**

Private liberal arts and sciences university.

Assistant Professor, Department of Economics

Taught six courses a year across international economics and macroeconomics, with data work and regressions in Excel on FRED, World Bank, and trade data, and advised undergraduate research

and honors projects. Conducted research alongside teaching.

2007–2012 **University of Minnesota, Department of Economics**

Public research university in Minneapolis–Saint Paul.

Lead Instructor, Principles of Macroeconomics (2010–2012)

Created and maintained the common Principles of Macroeconomics curriculum used by every instructor of the course, as many as eight in a single semester.

Instructor (2007–2012)

Taught large lectures of up to 400 students.

Publications

Peer-Reviewed Academic Journal Articles

1. "Measuring Academic Mindset in Economics Courses," co-authored with 25 others. *International Review of Economics Education*, vol. 52, June 2026.
2. "Blockchain Governance in the Wild," co-authored with Kevin Werbach, Primavera De Filippi, and Josh Tan. *Cryptoeconomic Systems*, vol. 3, no. 1, April 22, 2024. Media coverage: BlockchainGov Newsletter.
3. "Designing Effective Assessments in Economics Courses: Guiding Principles." *The Journal of Economic Education*, 55:1, 63–76, 2024.
4. "Taxing Blockchain Forks," joint with Mattia Landoni. *Stanford Journal of Blockchain Law & Policy*, vol. 3, no. 2, June 27, 2020.
5. "Financial Regulations and Price Inconsistencies across Bitcoin Markets," with Sofia Vivanco. *Information Economics and Policy*, June 2017, vol. 39(C).

Other Publications, Reviewed Notes

6. "Cambridge Digital Mining Industry Report: Global Operations, Sentiment, and Energy Use," co-authored with Alexander Neumueller, Kamiar Mohaddes, Valentin Rousseau, and Bryan Zhang. Cambridge: University of Cambridge, CCAF, April 2025. Media coverage: The Block, CryptoSlate, The Energy Mag, BeInCrypto, Sustainability Online, Crowdfund Insider.
7. "Crypto-Currencies and Crypto-Assets: An Introduction," with Alexandre Olbrecht. *Eastern Economic Journal*, vol. 49, no. 2, pp. 201–205, April 2023.
8. "3rd Global Cryptoasset Benchmarking Study," co-authored with A. Blandin, Y. Wu, T. Eisermann, A. Dek, S. Taylor, and Damaris Njoki. Cambridge: University of Cambridge, CCAF, September 2020. Media coverage: Cointelegraph, Asia Times, Bitcoin News, Cryptopotato, Crypto.news, Crowdfund Insider.
9. "2nd Global Cryptoasset Benchmarking Study," co-authored with Michel Rauchs, Apolline Blandin, Kristina Klein, Martino Recanatini, and Bryan Zheng Zhang. Cambridge: University of Cambridge, CCAF, December 2018. Media coverage: Bloomberg, Cointelegraph, FXStreet, Forbes Italia, CoinGape, Crowdfund Insider.
10. "Distributed Ledger Technology Systems: A Conceptual Framework," with Michel Rauchs, Andrew Glidden, Brian Gordon, Martino Recanatini, François Rostand, Kathryn Vagneur, and Bryan Zheng Zhang. Cambridge: University of Cambridge, CCAF, August 2018. Media coverage: The Register, Crowdfund Insider.
11. "The Potential Impact of Decentralized Virtual Currency on Monetary Policy." Federal Reserve Bank of Dallas, Globalization and Monetary Policy Institute, *2016 Annual Report*, April 2017, pp. 20–25.
12. "Blockchain Technology Disrupting Traditional Records Systems," with Christoffer Koch. Federal Reserve Bank of Dallas, *Financial Insights*, vol. 6(2), Second Quarter 2017, pp. 1–3.

Book Chapters

13. "Digital Currencies and Central Banks," Chapter 6, *The Palgrave Handbook of Technological Finance*, September 2021.
14. "Private and Hybrid Blockchains and Applications," with Sean Stein Smith, *The Emerald Handbook of Blockchain for Business*, 2021, Chapter 6, pp. 83–98.

Unpublished Papers or Work in Progress

Cryptoasset Markets and/or Blockchain-enabled Decentralization

1. "Bitcoin Reveals Exchange Rate Manipulation and Detects Capital Controls." Resting. Media coverage: The Telegraph, Bitcoin News, Finance Magnates, Breaker Mag.
2. "Are Cryptocurrency Markets Price Efficient? Depends on the Data Source." Resting.

Quantitative Investment Research

3. "Robust Search: Exploiting Tolerance To Optimize Trading Strategies." Working paper, in progress.
4. "Manufactured Premia: How Universe Construction Creates the Crypto Cross-Section," co-authored with Chelsea Canon. Working paper, in progress.

International Macroeconomics and Trade

5. "The Effect of Income Inequality on Import Prices." Resting. An earlier version was titled "How Does Income Inequality Affect Imports?" (2017).
6. "The Composition of the Allocation Puzzle through Time." Resting.
7. "Re-evaluating Stylized Business Cycle Facts for Developed and Developing Countries." Resting.

Economics Pedagogy and Teaching Practices

8. "Seeking Teachers: Changes in US Academic Economics Department Jobs," co-authored with Christopher J. Roark. Resting.
9. "A Guide to the U.S. Academic Economics Job Market for Teaching-Focused Jobs," co-authored with Melanie Fox, Ben Harrell, Nakul Kumar, Daniel J. Lee, & Allison Luedtke. Resting.

(2007 to 2026) Instructor of Record Teaching Experience

Taught courses from non-calculus principles to calculus- and programming-based intermediate theory, a master's course, and a Ph.D. course, at four institutions, for classes of 8 to 400 students, in standard and accelerated formats, in person and online. Designed all homework and exams for every course. Graded all work at Trinity; at the University of Minnesota and the University of Chicago, graded some and oversaw the grading of the rest. Hired and managed teams of up to nine teaching assistants per course at a time. Intentionally selected assessment method and frequency as appropriate to the course. Redesigned course assessment and delivery for COVID-era teaching.

2026 **Collegio Internazionale Ca' Foscari, Venice**

Instructor, DoCRA Colloquium

1. Ph.D. course: Risk and Benefits of Digitized Money and Assets

2018–2024 **The University of Chicago, Chicago, Illinois**

Visiting Instructor, Harris School of Public Policy (2024)

1. Macroeconomics (a macroeconomics policy course)

Lecturer/Assistant Instructional Professor, Economics Department (2018–2024): 5 courses/year, 10–162 students per section, 1 TA per 50 students

Standard courses (9–10 week courses, offered either entirely in person or entirely online)

1. Principles of Macroeconomics (Econ 10200; no calculus or other prerequisites)
2. International Monetary Systems (Econ 17110; prerequisite: Principles of Macro; writing-intensive)
3. The Elements of Economic Analysis I (Econ 20000; Intermediate Micro: calculus-based consumer theory)
4. The Elements of Economic Analysis II (Econ 20100; Intermediate Micro: calculus-based producer theory)
5. The Elements of Economic Analysis III (Econ 20200; Intermediate Macro: DGE + beginning MATLAB programming)
6. Economic Policy Analysis (Econ 23950; Intermediate Macro: calculus- and programming-based (MATLAB or Python), writing-intensive)

Accelerated courses (5- to 6-week courses)

7. The Elements of Economic Analysis II (Econ 20100; calculus-based producer theory, intermediate micro)
8. Economic Policy Analysis (Econ 23950; calculus- and programming-based (MATLAB or Python), writing-intensive)

Co-taught courses

9. MA Thesis Development Workshop (macroeconomics and finance specialization)

10. Pathways in Economics, Non-calculus (Econ 12410; High School Summer Program)
11. Pathways in Economics, Calculus-based (Econ 12411; High School Summer Program)
12. A Survey of Chicago Economics (Econ 12412; Specialized Summer Survey Program)

Financial Mathematics Program: a summer overload, outside the Economics Department appointment

13. Cryptoasset Markets (master's course, FINM 31000, a 5- to 6-week accelerated course)

2012–2018 **Trinity University, San Antonio, Texas**

Assistant Professor, Department of Economics: 6 courses/year, 8–35 students, no TAs or graders

1. Principles of Microeconomics (no calculus or other prerequisites)
2. Principles of Macroeconomics (no calculus; Micro principles prerequisite)
3. International Trade (no calculus; Macro principles prerequisite; writing-intensive: 15-page research paper)
4. International Monetary Systems (no calculus; Micro principles prerequisite; writing-intensive: 15 pages)

2007–2012 **University of Minnesota, Minneapolis, Minnesota**

Lead Instructor, Principles of Macroeconomics (2010–2012)

1. Principles of Macroeconomics (created and maintained a uniform curriculum across 8 instructors)

Instructor (2007–2012): 3 courses/year

1. Principles of Macroeconomics: 2009–2012, Large Lecture Instructor (150–400 students, 2–9 TAs)
2. 2008: Intermediate Macroeconomics (calculus-based) (15–40 students, 0–1 TAs)

Teaching Assistant (2007–2008)

1. Principles of Microeconomics and Principles of Macroeconomics